

VIRLESS® CREAM

Ingredient(s):

Each gram contains:

Acyclovir 50mg

Description(s):

A white to off-white color cream.

Pharmacodynamics:

Acyclovir is a synthetic purine nucleoside analogue with *in vitro* and *in vivo* inhibitory activities against human herpes viruses, including Herpes Simplex virus (HSV) types 1 and 2, Varicella Zoster viruses (VZV), Epstein Barr virus (EBV) and Cytomegalovirus (CMV). In cell culture, acyclovir has the greatest antiviral activity against HSV-1, followed (in decreasing order of potency) by HSV-2, VZV, EBV and CMV. The inhibitory activity of acyclovir for HSV-1, HSV-2, VZV, EBV and CMV is highly selective. The enzyme thymidine kinase (TK) of normal, non-infected cell does not use acyclovir effectively as a substrate, hence toxicity to mammalian host cells is low; however, TK encoded by HSV, VZV and EBV convert acyclovir to acyclovir monophosphate, a nucleoside analogue, which is further converted to the diphosphate and finally to the triphosphate by cellular enzymes. Acyclovir triphosphate interferes with the viral DNA polymerase and inhibits viral DNA replication with resultant chain termination following its incorporation into the viral DNA.

Prolonged or repeated courses of acyclovir in severely immune-compromised individuals may result in the selection of virus strains with reduced sensitivity, which may not respond to continued acyclovir treatment. Most of the clinical isolates with reduced sensitivity have been relatively deficient in viral TK; however, strains with altered viral TK or DNA polymerase have also been reported. *In vitro* exposure of HSV isolates to acyclovir can also lead to the emergence of less sensitive strains. The relationship between the *in vitro*-determined sensitivity of HSV isolates and clinical response to acyclovir therapy is not clear.

Pharmacokinetics:

Most of the acyclovir is excreted unchanged by the kidney. Renal clearance of acyclovir is substantially greater than creatinine clearance, indicating that tubular secretion in addition to glomerular filtration contributes to the renal elimination of the drug. 9-Carboxymethoxy-methylguanine is the only significant metabolite of acyclovir and accounts for approximately 10-15% of the administered dose recovered from the urine.

When acyclovir is given 1 hr after 1g of probenecid, the terminal half-life and the area under the plasma concentration-time curve is extended by 18 and 40%, respectively.

Clinical pharmacology studies designed to evaluate the dermal tolerance, systemic toxicity and percutaneous absorption of acyclovir showed that acyclovir levels in plasma was found from < 0.01 to 0.28µg/ml with normal renal function, and from < 0.01 to 0.78µg/ml with impaired renal function. Acyclovir excreted in the urine ranged from < 0.02 to 9.4% of the daily dose. Therefore, systemic absorption of acyclovir after topical application is minimal.

Indication(s):

Skin infections caused by Herpes Simplex Virus including initial and recurrent genital herpes and herpes labialis.

Dosage and Administration:

Adult / Children: Apply 5 times daily at approximately 4 hourly intervals. Treatment should be continued for 5 days. If after 5 days, healing is not complete then treatment may be continued for a further 5 days. Therapy should begin as early as possible after the start of an infection, and for recurrent episodes this should preferably be during the prodromal period or when the lesions first appear.

Mode of Administration:

To be applied topically

Contraindication(s):

Contraindicated in patients who develop hypersensitivity or intolerance to any of the components of the formulation.

Precaution(s) / Warning(s):

1. Virless Cream is intended for cutaneous use only, and not recommended for application to mouth, buccal or vaginal mucous membranes. It is also should not be used in the eye.
2. The recommended dosage, frequency of applications, and length of treatment should not be exceeded.
3. Clinical experience has identified no interactions resulting from topical administration of other drugs concomitantly with Virless Cream.
4. Acyclovir should not be used during pregnancy unless the potential benefit justifies the potential risk to the fetus.
5. No information is available on the effects of administration of Virless Cream during human pregnancy. Systemic administration of acyclovir to rats and rabbits did not produce embryotoxic or teratogenic effects. No information is available on levels of acyclovir which may appear in breast milk after administration of Virless Cream.

Drug Interaction(s):

Probenecid increases the mean half-life and area under the plasma concentration curve of systemically-administered acyclovir. Other drugs affecting renal physiology could potentially influence the pharmacokinetics of acyclovir. However, clinical experience has not identified other drug interactions with acyclovir.

Side Effect(s) / Adverse Reaction(s):

Transient burning and stinging, pruritis and rash may occur after local applications.

Symptoms and Treatment for Overdosage, and Antidote(s):

Overdosage by topical application of Virless Cream is unlikely because of limited transcutaneous absorption. It is unlikely that serious toxic effects would occur if a dose of up to 5g were applied on a single dose. Doses of acyclovir in excess of 5g warrants close observation of the patient. Acyclovir is dialysable by haemodialysis.

Shelf-Life:

3 years from the date of manufacture.

Storage Condition(s):

Keep in an airtight container. Store at temperature below 30°C. Protect from light and moisture.

Packing(s):

Aluminium tube of 5g, 10g.

VIRLESS® CREAM

Bahan aktif:

Setiap gram mengandungi:

Acyclovir 50mg

Indikasi:

Infeksi kulit yang disebabkan oleh Virus Herpes Simplex termasuk permulaan dan perulangan genital herpes dan herpes labialis.

Dos:

Sapu di bahagian yang terlibat lima kali sehari selama lima hari. Rawatan mestilah diulangi selama 5 hari jika penyakit belum sembuh. Terapi mestilah dimulakan secepat mungkin jikajangkitan berulang lagi.



Manufacturer and Product Registration Holder:
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